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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 10

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Registro en una agencia de empleo

Consultant: Good morning, Citywide Recruitment. How can I help?

Jobseeker: Hi, I'd like to register with your agency to look for work.

Consultant: Certainly, I can take your details now. Can I start with your name?

Jobseeker: Yes, my first name is Daniel, and my surname is Farrelly.

Consultant: Could you spell the surname?

Jobseeker: Of course - F-A-R-R-E-L-L-Y.

Consultant: Thanks. I ask because we sometimes receive applications with a single letter missing, and then an employer cannot match the paperwork to the person. Have you registered with Citywide before?

Jobseeker: No, this is my first time. I moved here at the beginning of the month, so I am still finding out which firms recruit locally.

Consultant: In that case, I should explain the process. Today I will create your profile and discuss the roles that might suit you. If you decide to apply for one, we send your details to the employer only after you have approved the job description. There is no charge to you at any stage.

Jobseeker: That sounds straightforward.

Consultant: Thank you. And the best number to reach you on?

Jobseeker: It's my mobile - 07816 445230.

Consultant: Let me just check - 07816 445230. Great. Now, what kind of work are you looking for?

Jobseeker: I was thinking warehouse work - actually, no, I'd really prefer office administration. That's where my strengths are.

Consultant: Administration, good. And when would you be available to start?

Jobseeker: I'm free immediately - I finished my last contract a fortnight ago.

Consultant: That gives us some flexibility. Are you hoping for a permanent post, or would you consider another temporary contract while you look?

Jobseeker: My preference is permanent work, but I would accept a contract lasting at least six months. I would rather avoid a very short placement because I want time to learn the organisation properly.

Consultant: And would a journey across town be manageable?

Jobseeker: Yes, provided the office is near a bus route. I do not drive, but the buses from my neighbourhood are reliable until quite late.

Consultant: Excellent, employers love that. Do you have relevant experience?

Jobseeker: Most of my background is in retail - I managed a small shop for three years, so I'm used to dealing with customers and paperwork.

Consultant: That's useful. And your highest qualification?

Jobseeker: I have a diploma in business studies.

Consultant: Noted. One more thing - do you speak any other languages? Some of our clients value that.

Jobseeker: Yes, I speak French fairly fluently.

Consultant: Excellent. What computer skills should I put down? Employers often ask specifically about spreadsheets and diary systems.

Jobseeker: I use word-processing and spreadsheet software every day, and in my last job I organised the manager's electronic diary. I also dealt with invoices. I have not used specialist accounting software, though.

Consultant: That's fine. We can offer a short online course if a vacancy requires it. I should also ask about working hours. You mentioned public transport, so would early mornings be difficult?

Jobseeker: A start before seven would be awkward. Normal office hours are ideal, and I could occasionally stay late. I am also available on Saturdays, although I would prefer not to work every weekend.

Consultant: Good. I'll note all of that. References can wait until an employer requests them, but it helps to warn two former supervisors now.

Jobseeker: I can contact my previous manager and the owner of the shop today.

Consultant: Wonderful. Now, let me tell you about a few vacancies we have. First, there's a Receptionist role in the city centre, full-time, paying £11.50 an hour. Then we have an Office Assistant position - that one's out at Riverside, it's part-time, and it pays £12 an hour. And finally, a Data Clerk job, also in the city centre, but the hours are evenings only, at £13 an hour.

Jobseeker: The Office Assistant one sounds ideal, actually.

Consultant: It does seem the closest match. The Receptionist post involves a lot of face-to-face work and starts at half past seven, while the Data Clerk role is quieter but finishes after the last bus to your area. At Riverside, the Office Assistant works from ten until three on four weekdays. The employer may extend the hours after the first three months.

Jobseeker: That timetable would be perfect. What would I actually be doing?

Consultant: Mostly arranging appointments, preparing simple reports and answering email enquiries. There is some telephone work, but another colleague covers the reception desk. They want someone accurate and calm rather than someone with a particular degree.

Jobseeker: That sounds close to what I did in the shop office.

Consultant: Exactly. Your customer experience is relevant, and your business qualification supports the administrative side. Before I submit the application, send me your latest employment dates. You can attach them to the reply when my message arrives.

Consultant: Great - I'll put you forward for it. I'll email you the full description this afternoon, and we'll arrange an interview.

Jobseeker: Thank you so much for your help.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Servicios de la biblioteca

Hello everyone, and thank you for coming to this short talk about your local library and the services we offer. I'm the head librarian here, and I'd like to run through what's available, including some exciting additions. Let me start with what's new this year. We've just launched an e-book lending service, so you can now borrow digital titles and read them on your phone or tablet at home. We've also opened a set of bookable study rooms on the upper floor, which have been in great demand from students. Now, some of you will ask about the café and the free wifi - those aren't new, they've been with us for several years. And our children's area is currently being renovated, so please bear with us there. The distinction matters because the leaflet you may have picked up was printed before the work was finished.

The café has new chairs, but it is still the same service, and the wireless network has only had a routine upgrade. The children's area will look different when it reopens next month, yet it is a refurbishment rather than an additional facility. By contrast, neither digital borrowing nor reservable rooms existed here last year. To use the digital collection, sign in with the number on your card and create a four-digit personal code. You may keep an electronic title for up to three weeks, after which it disappears automatically, so there can be no late charge. The study rooms hold between two and six people. They are intended for quiet group work, and bookings can be made for ninety minutes at a time through our website. Now, on to membership and borrowing.

Joining the library is completely free for local residents. Once you're a member, you can borrow up to twelve items at any one time - books, audiobooks, or DVDs. The standard loan period is three weeks, and you can renew online if no one else has reserved the item. If you do return something late, there's a small fine for each day it's overdue, so do keep an eye on your due dates. The twelve-item allowance is a total across all physical formats; it does not mean twelve books plus twelve films. Most members find that generous enough. The borrowing period applies equally to books and spoken-word recordings, although very popular films may have a shorter loan shown on the case. You will receive an email reminder two days before an item is due.

Please do not ignore it simply because online renewal is available: a reservation by another reader prevents renewal, and the daily charge begins the following morning. If cost is a concern, speak to us rather than leaving an overdue item at home. We can usually arrange payment over time, and charges are waived when a documented hospital stay or similar emergency caused the delay. Replacement costs are different from late charges, so ask a member of staff before buying another copy yourself. We also provide some services you might not know about. Members get free access to a wide range of online newspapers, which is perfect if you like to keep up with the news from around the world. For families, we run a story session for young children every Saturday morning - it's very popular, so arrive early.

And if you need to use a computer, our computer suite is on the first floor, with printing and scanning available. The newspaper database includes national titles as well as publications from more than forty countries. It can be used from home, whereas several specialist reference databases are available only inside the building. The Saturday activity for children begins at ten thirty and lasts

about forty minutes. It is designed mainly for ages four to seven, but younger brothers and sisters may sit with a parent. There is no booking fee. Computers may be reserved for an hour. Staff can show you how to log in or scan a document, though they cannot complete forms on your behalf. Black-and-white printing is inexpensive, and you add credit at the machine beside the stairs.

Visitors sometimes look for the computers on the ground floor because that is where the help desk stands, so remember to go up one level. Finally, if you'd like to join today, it couldn't be simpler. Just come to the main desk and bring proof of your address - a utility bill or a bank statement is fine - and we'll issue your card on the spot. A passport can confirm your identity, but on its own it does not show where you currently live, so it cannot replace that document. A digital bill displayed on your phone is acceptable as long as your name and current home are visible. Students living in halls may use an official letter from their college. Once the card is issued, please sign it and keep the welcome message: it explains how to reserve items, cancel a room and contact us outside opening hours.

Thank you for listening, and please do explore everything the library has to offer.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Proyecto de arquitectura

Tutor: Right, Maya, Josh - let's review your architecture project before your presentation. Tell me about the building you designed.

Maya: We designed a community library. We wanted a public space that would bring people of all ages together, not just a place to borrow books.

Tutor: Let me confirm that for the assessment record: the building itself is a community library. The sports hall shown beside it belongs to the existing school, and the railway station on your location map is simply a nearby landmark. Neither of those is your design proposal.

Maya: That's right. Our building combines books, digital resources, a children's room and a flexible meeting space. We chose that brief because residents said the neighbourhood lacked an indoor place where different generations could meet without having to buy anything.

Josh: We also visited two small libraries to observe how people moved through them. The successful one had clear sight lines and movable furniture. In the other, tall shelving blocked the entrance, so first-time visitors looked uncertain about where to go.

Tutor: A lovely idea. Where did the inspiration come from? I remember you mentioned a historic building at one point.

Josh: We did look at an old town hall for ideas, but in the end the main inspiration was the natural landscape around the site - the way the hills curve. The roofline actually echoes those hills.

Maya: A library in Denmark gave us ideas about daylight, and the town hall helped us think about a central entrance. But neither determined the form of our proposal. Once we traced the profile of the surrounding slopes, the whole plan began to make sense, including the lower roof over the children's area and the taller reading room facing the view.

Tutor: Good distinction. In the presentation, show the discarded sketches briefly, then make it clear which source guided the final shape. Otherwise the audience may assume that the historic façade was your principal model.

Tutor: That's a strong concept. And what did you build the main structure from?

Maya: We debated using concrete, because it's cheap and durable, but we finally chose timber. It's far more sustainable, and it gives the interior a really warm feel.

Josh: We considered a steel frame too, mainly because it could span the large reading room. Our calculations showed that engineered wooden beams could achieve the same span, however, and a local supplier could provide them. We still use a small amount of concrete in the foundations, but it is not the main structural system.

Tutor: That is a convincing decision, provided you acknowledge fire treatment and maintenance. Sustainability claims need evidence, so include the transport distance and the certification of the wood rather than saying all wood is automatically environmentally friendly.

Tutor: Good choice. Was there a particular difficulty you had to overcome?

Josh: Definitely. The hardest thing wasn't the budget or accessibility - it was the limited size of the site. It's quite a narrow plot, so fitting everything in without it feeling cramped took a lot of reworking.

Maya: The cost plan actually stayed within the target once we simplified the roof, and the ramp fitted along the eastern edge. The real constraint was width. We solved part of it by sharing circulation space: the broad central aisle can become an exhibition area, and the meeting room opens onto it with folding doors.

Tutor: That response shows useful development. Include an early plan and the revised one so the audience can see how the restricted plot changed your thinking.

Tutor: You've handled that well. Now, I looked at your scale model. It's beautifully made, but I have to say the scale isn't obvious - someone looking at it can't easily tell how big the building actually is. You might add a small human figure for reference.

Maya: That's a good point. We'll fix that.

Tutor: Before we discuss the sequence, who is speaking about which section?

Maya: I'll open with the research and overall concept. Josh will explain the structure, and then I'll cover the internal spaces. We plan to answer questions together.

Tutor: Sensible. Avoid swapping speakers every minute because that can feel restless. Each of you should complete a coherent section, while the other changes the slides and watches the clock.

Tutor: Now, for the presentation itself. Start with a clear introduction that sets out your aims - don't dive straight into the details. Then make sure you explain your choice of materials, because that's one of the strongest parts of your project. I'd also add a diagram showing the internal layout, so the audience can follow the flow of the spaces. And do rehearse beforehand to get your timing right; you've only got ten minutes. Practise once in front of me, and I'll give you some feedback afterwards.

Josh: That's really helpful - thank you.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La migración de las ballenas

Good afternoon. Today's lecture is about one of the great spectacles of the natural world - the migration of whales, some of which travel thousands of kilometres every year. Let's begin with why they migrate at all. Most large whales divide their year between two very different regions. In the cooler months they head towards the tropics, and the main reason is reproduction: they travel to warm breeding grounds, where their young have a better chance of surviving. In summer, by contrast, they return to the poles to feed, where the cold, nutrient-rich water is full of the tiny shrimp-like creatures called krill that form the bulk of their diet. During this feeding season a whale eats almost constantly, storing the energy as a thick layer of blubber that will sustain it through the long journey ahead.

These movements are seasonal rather than a simple response to one sudden change in weather. A breeding area offers relatively calm water and fewer dangers for a newborn calf, but it often contains too little nourishment for an adult to remain there throughout the year. A polar feeding area presents the opposite trade-off: prey is abundant during the productive months, although the water is demanding for a very young animal. Migration connects the advantages of both places. Not every individual follows precisely the same timetable. Pregnant females may leave first on the southward route, while younger animals sometimes depart later. On the return, mothers with calves often travel more slowly and stay close to sheltered coastlines.

Researchers therefore compare many records before describing any schedule as typical. Now, the distances involved are extraordinary. Grey whales, for example, make some of the longest journeys of any mammal on Earth, swimming from the Arctic all the way to the coast of Mexico. There, the females give birth in warm, shallow lagoons near the shore, which offer their calves protection from predators. A complete return trip can exceed sixteen thousand kilometres. The whales do not travel in a perfectly straight line, and they may pause where local currents concentrate prey. Scientists identify individuals from scars and markings on their tails, then compare photographs taken at different points along the coast.

More recently, temporary satellite tags have supplied positions from stretches of ocean where boats rarely operate. The sheltered water at the Mexican end of the route is especially valuable in the first weeks of a calf's life. It allows the calf to surface easily and remain beside its mother while building strength. The adult female eats very little there and depends on energy accumulated during the previous season. How do whales find their way across such vast stretches of open ocean? Scientists believe they may be able to detect the Earth's magnetic field, using it rather like a compass. They also rely heavily on sound, and some species produce long, complex songs that carry for many kilometres underwater and help them stay in contact.

The magnetic explanation remains a hypothesis rather than a complete answer. Whales may combine several cues, including the position of the sun, the direction of waves and familiar underwater features near a coast. Evidence from stranded animals suggests that unusual magnetic conditions can sometimes coincide with navigation errors, but the relationship is not simple. Sound is effective because it travels much farther through water than light. Low calls can maintain contact

between animals separated by great distances, while repeated patterns may also convey identity or breeding information. Researchers record these calls with underwater microphones. When the same pattern appears at two stations hours apart, it can help them estimate the direction in which an animal is moving.

Sadly, whales today face a number of serious threats. One of the most immediate is collision with ships along busy coastal routes, which kills or injures many animals every year. In addition, the growing noise from shipping and industry interferes with their communication, making it harder for them to find one another and to navigate. And in the longer term, rising sea temperatures are altering ocean currents and shifting the location of their food, forcing whales to change patterns of migration that have remained stable for thousands of years. Risk is not distributed evenly. Narrow approaches to busy ports create particular collision zones, so measures such as lower vessel speeds or temporary route changes can have a large effect.

Entanglement in fishing equipment is another danger, although it varies by region and species. Acoustic disturbance is harder to see: an animal may abandon a feeding area, call more loudly or fail to hear another whale before any physical injury is observed. Climate-driven changes add uncertainty because the whales may arrive at a traditional feeding ground after the seasonal peak in prey has moved elsewhere. A route learned over generations may then become less efficient. Long-term monitoring is essential: a single tagged trip shows what one animal did, whereas repeated observations reveal whether a population is gradually changing its timing or destination. Protecting these remarkable animals will require international cooperation - but understanding their journeys is the essential first step.